

The Starter Grimoire

Every tool, formula, and safety rule we wish someone had handed us on day one. Print it. Screenshot it. Share it with your one weird coworker who gets it.

9 Tools	3 Prompt Formulas	Safety Card	Decision Tree
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"The tools were always there. I just learned the spells."

— Merry, Corporate Witch

The Nine Tools Every Corporate Witch Needs

Not 50. Not 20. Nine. Each one earns its place by doing something the others can't. Master the stack and you will outperform 90% of your peers who are 'trying everything.'

■ Claude

Best for: Long-form writing, analysis, spreadsheets

Handles big documents, nuanced tone, and long context better than anyone. Upload a 50-page report and ask real questions. Your writing partner and research librarian.

Free Tier · Anthropic

■ ChatGPT

Best for: Versatile daily workhorse, image generation

The Swiss Army knife. Good at almost everything, great at very few things. Plus tier (\$20/mo) unlocks image generation and data analysis. Most people's first tool for a reason.

Free Tier · OpenAI

■ Perplexity

Best for: Research with actual sources

What Google was supposed to be. Every answer comes with citations. Use it for industry research, competitive intel, or anything where "where did you get that?" matters.

Free Tier · Perplexity AI

■ Kimi

Best for: Massive documents (2M+ tokens), free long-context work

The sleeper hit. When you need to feed an entire book, year of emails, or giant codebase into a single prompt without paying premium — Kimi's free context window dwarfs what Claude and ChatGPT paywall. A quiet unfair advantage.

Free Tier · Moonshot AI



■ Gemini

Best for: Google Workspace integration (Docs, Sheets, Gmail, Drive)

If your company runs on Google, Gemini lives inside your tools. Draft in Docs, analyze in Sheets, summarize Gmail threads — no copy-paste dance. Plus a free tier that competes head-to-head with ChatGPT Plus features.

Free Tier · Google

■ NotebookLM

Best for: Turning any document into a podcast-style audio brief

Upload your reading stack — PDFs, articles, meeting notes — and NotebookLM generates a two-host podcast discussing it. Listen on your commute instead of staring at a 40-page report. Disgustingly good for busy weeks.

Free Tier · Google

■ Otter.ai

Best for: Meeting notes, transcripts, action items

Transcribes meetings automatically, generates summaries, extracts action items. Works on Zoom, Teams, Google Meet. 300 min/month free. Silent, tireless intern.

Free Tier · Otter

■ Canva + Gamma

Best for: Decks, visuals, social content

Canva AI generates designs. Gamma generates whole presentations from a paragraph. Together they turn "blank deck panic" into "first draft in 15 minutes."

Free Tier · Canva/Gamma

■ Descript

Best for: Video + podcast editing by editing the transcript

Edit video and audio like a Word doc. Delete a sentence from the text, the video cut happens automatically. Remove ums, fix flubs, even change your words using voice cloning. The tool that turned "I'll start a podcast someday" into "I recorded one this weekend."

Free Tier · Descript



II The Three Prompt Formulas That Do 80% of the Work

Bad prompts = garbage answers. These three patterns cover most corporate tasks. Memorize them. Replace the brackets. Watch everything change.

1 • The R-T-F Formula (Role / Task / Format)

Use when: You need structured output. Reports, summaries, emails, analyses.

Act as a [ROLE].

Your task is to [TASK].

Format the response as [FORMAT].

Real example: "Act as a senior product marketing manager. Your task is to summarize this competitor's pricing page and flag 3 differences from our pricing. Format as a bulleted list with the one-line takeaway at the top."

2 • The Context-Constraint Formula

Use when: The default AI answer is too generic. You need it tuned to your situation.

Here is the context: [SITUATION / AUDIENCE / HISTORY]

Here are my constraints: [TIME, TONE, WHAT TO AVOID]

Now do this: [THE ASK]

Real example: "Here is the context: I'm a VP presenting Q3 numbers to a skeptical board that has seen 4 bad quarters. Constraints: 3 slides max, no fluff, tone: confident but not defensive. Now do this: outline what each slide says."

3 • The Critique-Then-Improve Formula

Use when: You already wrote something and want it sharper. This is the secret weapon.

Here is my draft: [YOUR TEXT]

Critique it honestly. What is weak? What is missing? What would a sharp editor cut?

Then rewrite it using your critique.

Real example: Paste your email. Ask this exact prompt. Most AIs will give you back a version that is 30% shorter and 2x clearer. The word "honestly" is the magic — without it you get polite feedback.





The Safety Card (Read Before You Paste Anything)

Most AI disasters happen in the first two weeks of usage because nobody taught these rules. They take 60 seconds to read and will save your job.

✗ NEVER paste into any AI tool:

- Customer names, emails, phone numbers, addresses
- Social security numbers, credit card numbers, bank info
- Medical records, patient info, HIPAA-protected data
- Internal source code, proprietary algorithms, trade secrets
- Salary information tied to named employees
- Anything marked "Confidential," "Internal Use Only," or NDA-covered
- Client contracts, legal documents in progress

✓ ALWAYS do this instead:

- Anonymize — replace names with Role 1, Role 2, Client A, Client B
- Strip identifying numbers — "a large medical center" not the real name
- Use enterprise AI if available (Copilot, ChatGPT Enterprise)
- Check your company's AI policy — it exists, it may surprise you
- Assume everything you paste may be used for training (act accordingly)
- When in doubt, ask AI to help you write a fictional analogous case
- Keep a personal "safe prompt" notebook for patterns you reuse



I V The Decision Tree — Which Tool for Which Job

The biggest mistake novices make is using one tool for everything. Each task has a best fit.

I need to... Write a long, nuanced document → Claude Best at long context, tone control, no truncation.	I need to... Research something new → Perplexity You need citations and current info — not AI memory from 2023.
I need to... Brainstorm 20 ideas fast → ChatGPT Fast, chatty, good at divergent thinking.	I need to... Make a deck → Gamma Paragraph in, deck out. Polish the 3 slides that matter.
I need to... Summarize a meeting → Otter.ai Runs in background. Summarizes + action items automatically.	I need to... Generate an image → ChatGPT / Canva AI ChatGPT for quick one-offs, Canva for editable designs.
I need to... Analyze a spreadsheet → Claude Upload, ask real questions. Best at 'what does this data mean?'	I need to... Rewrite something → Claude or ChatGPT Both work. Claude restrained, ChatGPT playful.
I need to... Learn a new concept → Claude + Perplexity Claude explains, Perplexity verifies. Belt and suspenders.	I need to... Feed a huge document (200+ pages) → Kimi Free massive context window. No 'document too long' errors.
I need to... Work inside Google Docs / Sheets / Gmail → Gemini Lives inside the Google tools you already use. No copy-paste dance.	I need to... Digest reading during my commute → NotebookLM Upload docs, get a podcast. Two AI hosts discuss it for you.
I need to... Edit a video or podcast fast → Descript Edit by editing the transcript. No timeline scrubbing ever again.	



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